

The Crossing Cabinet

A proposal can be fair, specific and still need evidence.

Fiction boundary: Seabrook, Niko and the cabinet are invented. Read this as a model of planning; do not use its details as research evidence.

A small choice at lunch

At Seabrook School, the paved strip near the crossing is busy for five minutes and quiet for the rest of lunch. Niko has noticed that students who are waiting for a sibling, sitting with a new friend or looking for a short game often have little to do there. He proposes a weatherproof cabinet with a few shared items: chalk, skipping ropes, card games and soft balls.

Niko's claim: Seabrook School should trial a Crossing Cabinet for four weeks, then use what it learns to decide whether the cabinet should continue.

First, a small collection of shared equipment could give students another way to join in. A good lunch area does not have to make every student play the same game; it should offer more than one safe way to connect. The cabinet would not replace the oval or the courts. It would make an overlooked strip more useful.

Second, a short trial would let the school test an idea before making a larger decision. Students and staff could note what is borrowed, what is returned and which items are actually useful. Those notes would help the school improve, stop or continue the idea.

Planning for a real question

Some people may reasonably worry that equipment could be lost, damaged or create extra work for staff. Ignoring that concern would make the proposal less trustworthy.

Niko's response: Begin with a small set of durable items, use a simple sign-out card and ask a rotating student team to check the cabinet at the end of lunch. A duty teacher could review the trial notes once a week. If the routine is not manageable, the school can change it before deciding whether to continue.

A measured next step

Niko is not promising that one cabinet will solve every lunchtime problem. He is asking the school to test one manageable action, listen to reasonable concerns and make its next decision with better information. That is a convincing plan, but it is not finished research.

Important: The reading has no verified facts, statistics or sources. In your own plan, attach each reason to a checked evidence note and source detail. Write **needs checking** when you cannot trace it.

Planning map

CLAIM

Names who should act and what they should do.

REASON

Explains why the action may matter to the audience.

EVIDENCE NOTE

Accurately records what an identified source says.

FAIR CONCERN

Names a question an undecided reader could reasonably ask.

RESPONSE

Answers the actual concern without inventing proof.

CONCLUSION

Returns to the action and asks the audience to decide or act.

Reading check

1. Paraphrase Niko's claim.
2. Underline a reason and name its audience benefit.
3. Box the fair concern. Why is it fair?
4. Draw an arrow from the concern to the response that answers it.
5. Explain why "The cabinet will make every lunch perfect" is an overclaim.

Before you draft

A model can show structure. Your assessment plan must use your own topic, your own checked sources and your own identified audience. Do not copy the fictional detail as evidence.